

Apocalypse nearing?

A giant ice shelf in Antarctica is set to disappear within a decade, says NASA.
<http://dgit.in/1IGNUUI>



Die locksmith, die!

This robot can crack combination locks in seconds:
<http://dgit.in/1dfgCiy>

DO



subversive, often times quite risqué, and rather culturally complex to be thought up by corporate entities. Although, there have been exceptions such as the *The Man Your Man Could Smell Like* commercials by Old Spice, which have a distinctive meme-like quality to them.

Meme Hierarchy

To sum it up: memes are invariably user generated, extremely hard to understand, require a fair grasp of the underlying context, and are popular enough to break

into the mainstream. Now that you have some idea of what constitutes a meme, it's time to learn how to ride the meme train. That is, how you do memes right.

To make great memes, it's imperative to understand where they originate from. Sure, you have witnessed some really funny ones that you actually understood, but they were shared by some snotty kid on your Facebook feed. That's a terrible starting point because Facebook is where memes go to die. In other words: by the time a meme is popular enough to trickle

down to the popular social networking websites, it's already too stale and over-used to be funny.

What you need is an introduction to meme hierarchy. To understand this concept, just assume that you aren't dealing with memes, but with diamonds instead. By that analogy, Facebook, Twitter, and other social networks are the jewellery shops that receive the cut and polished diamonds. In short, this isn't the place where memes are made. They are usually created in large forums with subscribers ranging in millions. The best example would be imageboards such as 4chan, which interestingly accounts for creating an overwhelmingly large number of memes.

Reddit: Socially Curating Memes

However, like any large system, such forums are inherently entropic. The rare gem of a meme is usually buried beneath millions of metaphorical rocks. You can't get to the diamonds unless you sift them from rocks in a large processing plant. This is where Reddit comes in. The meme-worthy stuff from 4chan and other Internet forums makes its way into Reddit, where users decide whether it gets up-voted or down-voted. With a membership large enough to ensure that entries reach hundreds of millions of eyeballs, the members of Reddit are essentially unpaid mine workers that sift diamonds from rocks by exercising their voting privileges.

After a meme has made it big on Reddit, you have what metaphorically resembles an uncut and unpolished rock. From here onwards, the raw template for a particular meme is created for the convenience of Internet users by websites that specialise in making meme generators. These websites allow users to co-opt as well as modify popular memes to create even more impressive iterations. This usually happens when memes popularised on Reddit are picked up by the Cheezburger network, or other entities that provide free templatised meme generation tools. Websites such as Meme Generator, Quick Meme, and Live Meme provide such tools that make it easy for anyone to modify existing templates of popular memes to create their own iterations.

